

Simple definition: A class method used to create an object in a different way than the default constructor is called an alternative constructor.

Why we use it?

- When data comes in different format
- When reading from file
- When reading from data base
- When taking input as string.

Problem Statement

Create a class Employee that

- Take name and salary in a normal constructor
- Has a class method that create an object from a string like "Kish-5000"

dir(), dict() and help() method

① dir() function.

dir() shows all the attribute and method of an object.

Example 1. With string

```
name = "Kish"
print(dir(name))
```

③ `help()` Function
`help()` gives documentation details about an object

It explains

- what it does
- what method it has
- how to use it

Example (1)

`help(str)`

- all string method
- explain of each method

`help(len)`

Explain what `len()` does and how to use it

Exercise Object inspector using `dir()`

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you will see many methods like upper, lower, replace, strip, split and many more.

Example 2 with your own class

class student:

```
def __init__(self, name, marks):  
    self.name = name  
    self.marks = marks
```

```
s1 = student("krish", 90)  
print(dir(s1))
```

you will see
name, marks, __init__, __dict__ and many
special method.

Simply `dir()` = "what all thing are inside this" ^{Object}

② (`--dict--`) Attribute

`--dict--` show the data stored inside an object
in dictionary form.

It only show variable not method

→ `print(s1.__dict__)`

`{'name': 'krish', 'marks': 90}`

• It show variable name and their value.